CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 13: **Saving the Gharial** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which sentence from a conservation poster best reflects the chapter's message? 1

(a) Fish is more valuable than reptiles.
(b) Rivers do not need care.
(c) Capture every gharial to be safe.
(d) Protect the river and the gharial will live.

2. Why would gharial nests be raided less often if camouflaged well? 1

(a) rivers dry up **(b)** hyenas fear sand
(c) eggs hatch faster **(d)** predators cannot easily find them

3. A mother gharial mistakes an object for one of her young. This suggests that her instinct to guard is: 1

(a) absent
(b) strong enough to override careful checking
(c) weak
(d) learnt from humans

4. Fear of wildlife can worsen a species' decline because: 1

(a) animals fear people more
(b) frightened people may kill or ignore the animals
(c) fear fills the rivers
(d) fear increases breeding

5. Which animal named in the chapter is a danger to nests? 1

(a) gharial **(b)** hyena **(c)** elephant **(d)** tiger

6. Which is the most logical reason why releasing captive-bred gharials did not secure their survival at Satkosia? 1

(a) they forgot how to breed **(b)** the river itself was unsafe for them
(c) they were released in winter **(d)** they refused to swim

7. Which word is closest in meaning to 'camouflage' as used for the nests? 1

(a) disguise **(b)** decorate **(c)** move **(d)** break

8. The word 'survival' in the title idea 'species' survival' refers to: 1

(a) continuing to exist **(b)** breeding in zoos
(c) winning a race **(d)** leaving a place

9. If dams stop sand banks from forming downstream, the gharial would most likely suffer because: 1

(a) it needs sand for nesting **(b)** it needs cold water
(c) it eats sand **(d)** it cannot swim

10. Choose the correct sentence: 1

(a) The gharial's snout is slender, which helps it catch fish.
(b) The gharial snout are slender, which help it catch fish.
(c) The gharials snout is slender which help catch fish.
(d) The gharial's snout, is slender, which helping it catch fish.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Calculate the fall in the gharial's range and express it as a fraction. 2

12. Why is saving rivers also good for humans? 2

13. How does the jaw-clap observation add to our understanding of the gharial? 2

14. What does a mother's mistaking an object for her baby show? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Explain how dams, nets and floods together threaten the gharial. 3

16. Write a note on 'fear of wildlife' as a barrier to conservation. 3

17. What does the figure '2 of 7' suggest about planning future releases? 3

OR

Analyse the importance of observation in Whitaker's work. 3

18. Why is the passage about 30 years of conservation important to the message? 3

OR

Compare a male gharial's fights with sword-fights. Is the comparison effective? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Write a magazine article (about 150 words) titled 'The Gharial: Guardian of Our Rivers'. 5

OR

Imagine you are a gharial hatchling on the Chambal. Write a short narrative of your first month. 5

20. Evaluate Project Crocodile: what worked and what did not? 5

OR

Explain the importance of scientific observation and patience in conservation, with details from the chapter. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks